intersex
NIGERIA
CENTER FOR HEALTHCARE DEVELOPMENT & YOUTH EMPOWERMENT

INTERSEX NIGERIA

CENTER FOR HEALTHCARE DEVELOPMENT AND YOUTH EMPOWERMENT

Forging Forward for Impact and Sustainability

2024 ANNUAL REPORT

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CONTENTS

Copyright	i-ii
About Us	2
Our Strategic Priorities	3
Our Vision and Mission	4
Message from the Board Chair	5-6
Message from the Executive Director	7
Our Partnership with Federal Ministry of Health & Social Welfare	8
Intersex Nigeria at 5	9
2024 Project and Activities	10-20
Field Impact Stories	21
Movement Building & Partnerships	22 - 33
Lessons and Challenges	34
Looking Ahead	35
2024 Financial Audit Report Summary	36-37
Appreciation	38

About us

Intersex Nigeria is an intersex-led non-profit organisation founded in 2019 and officially registered in 2021. We are dedicated to advancing the rights, health and dignity of intersex persons in Nigeria and beyond. Guided by the principles of bodily autonomy, self-determination and social justice, we champion sexual and reproductive health, mental wellbeing, and human rights for intersex people through advocacy, research, empowerment and community-building initiatives.

Our work ranges from grassroots support (creating safe spaces, peer networks and educational resources) to national and regional advocacy that drives inclusive policies and strengthens healthcare systems. We collaborate with families, stakeholders, and partners to increase awareness and recognition of intersex rights, while mobilising resources that improve the safety, wellbeing and quality of life of intersex persons.

Our Strategic Priorities

Movement Building and Partnership

We collaborate and network with other rights-based groups and networks to build a resilient intersex movement, enhancing the visibility of intersex persons over time

Research and Advocacy

We conduct thorough research to understand the human rights issues affecting the communities we serve. We document human rights violations, collect data and gather testimonies from affected individuals to build evidence for advocacy campaigns.

Public Engagements

We organise events to improve the perception of the public on variations of sex characteristics and overcome structural barriers towards reducing all forms of stigma and discrimination and other human rights violations against intersex persons.

Capacity Strengthening & Building

We provide a comprehensive roadmap for systems strengthening aimed at organisational development,. By integrating best practices and emerging technology, we equip both intersex persons and our team with essential life competency skills.

Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights (SRHR) and Mental Wellbeing

We develop and implement comprehensive sexuality education programs that provide accurate information about sexual and reproductive health, including topics such as contraception, HIV and STI prevention, consent, gender equality and reproductive rights.

Our Vision

Our vision is to see a society where intersex persons, from birth, have rights to bodily integrity and autonomy and are free from stigma and discrimination.

Our Mission

Our mission is to create an enabling society that promotes the visibility, inclusion, bodily autonomy, sexual and reproductive health including mental well-being and human rights of intersex persons in Nigeria, through community organizing, research, advocacy, and public engagements using a feminist lens.

Message from the Board Chair

This year marked five years since Intersex Nigeria was founded. For any organisation working on the margins of public conversation, getting to five years is not something we take lightly. It is evidence of perseverance, clarity of purpose and an unshakable commitment to a community that has long been ignored or spoken for.

Looking back at where we started, the landscape was stark. There was no national conversation about intersex people and little room to speak honestly about the violence that begins at birth and follows many intersex individuals through life. The existence of Intersex Nigeria challenged that silence and continues to do so.

2024 reminded us that our work is still urgent. The team deepened its regional footprint with community engagements in Cameroon. They brought intersex education into spaces that have traditionally excluded non-conforming narratives.

They launched data collection efforts in hospitals, created training manuals, produced storytelling tools like documentaries and stage plays, sensitised NYSC corps members and opened space for younger activists to learn and lead.

These are tangible outcomes. But beyond the numbers, what stands out to me is the way Intersex Nigeria is building a new kind of infrastructure rooted in trust, visibility and collective care.

As a Board, our responsibility is to provide governance and oversight, as well as to protect the vision and long-term sustainability of this work. We are proud of how the team has continued to adapt by shifting in response to cultural contexts, learning from implementation gaps and staying anchored in the realities of intersex people themselves.

Anniversaries invite reflection. They ask us to take stock of what we have done and what still needs to be done.

We know there are still hospitals performing non-consensual surgeries. We know many intersex people in Nigeria and the region are still living in isolation. We know legal recognition remains out of reach. These are not abstract problems. They are the daily realities we are organising to change.

To our staff, thank you for your grit and care. To our partners and funders, thank you for walking alongside us with respect and for your flexibility.

And to intersex people across Nigeria and West Africa, you are not alone. You are not an afterthought. You are at the centre of why this organisation exists and you always will be.

As we look to the next five years, our commitment remains to keep showing up with honesty to protect what we have built and to push further toward justice.

Sendi Dafwat
Board Chair, Intersex Nigeria

Message from the Executive Director

This year, Intersex Nigeria turned five.

Five years of pushing against silence. Five years of saying no to harmful norms dressed up as care. Five years of standing with intersex people in Nigeria whose lives have too often been written out of public health, advocacy, and law.

2024 was one of movement and momentum. We launched our research on how intersex genital mutilation continues in Nigerian hospitals today. We brought our findings to the **Federal Ministry of Health and Social Welfare** as well as into the hands of frontline healthcare workers who are ready to do better.

We continued our grassroots engagements, training health providers and traditional birth attendants, meeting with community leaders and deepening our partnerships across states.

We created space for joy and visibility. And we marked Intersex Awareness Day with the launch of the **VIRAL Report**. We did this while remaining rooted in our goal to improve the lives of intersex persons.

None of this would have been possible without the resilience of our community, team members and the trust placed in us by our partners and donors. To our team, thank you for your hard work and commitment to our mission. To our community members, thank you for your courage and your willingness to stand with us.

As we look ahead, we remain committed to advancing dignity, inclusion and rights for all intersex persons. We will continue to build partnerships, amplify voices and push for the change our community deserves.

Obioma Chukwuike

Executive Director, Intersex Nigeria

A Year of Grounded Advocacy and Expanding Visibility

In 2024, we took our advocacy straight to the heart of Nigeria's health system by strengthening our partnership with the **Federal Ministry of Health and Social Welfare** and other high-level stakeholders. We reviewed how national health policies handle intersex variations and discussed ways to stop harmful, non-consensual surgeries.

Our work is still growing, but each meeting moved us closer to a future where intersex Nigerians can walk into any health facility and get respectful care without fear or secrecy.

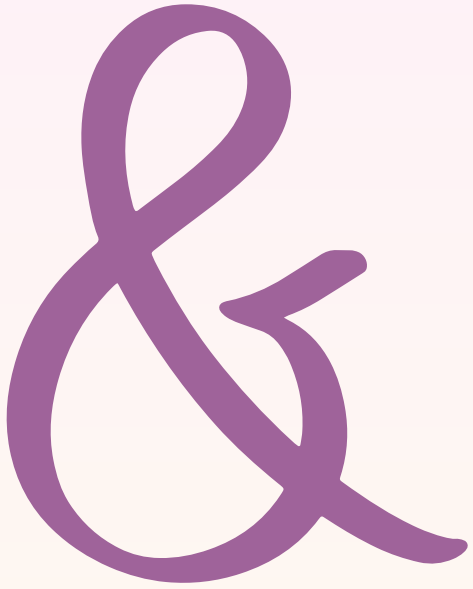
Our Fifth Anniversary!

When Intersex Nigeria began in November, 2019, there were no national conversations about intersex rights, no safe spaces for intersex Nigerians to speak freely, and very little language to describe our realities. Intersex was founded as a response to the increasing needs for intersex visibility, response to stigma and harmful medical practices including IGM.

Five years later, our existence is a declaration that we are still here, growing, building and refusing to be erased.

To commemorate this milestone, we hosted a series of internal and external reflections. We documented lessons learned, revisited our founding vision and engaged our community to dream forward. This anniversary went beyond celebration to grounding ourselves in why we started and why we must continue.

Projects



Activities

World Untold Stage Play

In March 2024, Intersex Nigeria presented ***World Untold*: *Echoes of Silence*** in Abuja, a groundbreaking stage play that blended personal stories, cultural reflections and social critique to illuminate the lived realities of intersex persons in Nigeria.

It was performed in a **700-capacity** auditorium in the Federal Capital Territory and it drew a wide audience that included representatives from government ministries and agencies, the National Human Rights Commission, healthcare professionals (including medical doctors and psychologists), human rights activists, intersex persons, individuals of diverse identities and members of the general public.

The production was a platform for education and empathy and it featured authentic portrayals that challenged myths and misconceptions about intersex persons. The play sparked emotional responses and meaningful conversations among attendees. Many described the experience as deeply moving, with themes that lingered long after the performance.

World Untold*: *Echoes of Silence demonstrated the power of art to inspire awareness and drive advocacy. The play contributed to national discussions on inclusion and equality, leaving a lasting mark on Nigeria's human rights and cultural landscape.

Sustaining Intersex Advocacy Through Youth Engagement

As part of the **We Lead Project**, we took intersex education to the National Youth Service Corps (NYSC) Orientation Camp in **Kubwa**, **Abuja**. For two days, our team engaged young Nigerians on what it means to be intersex, the realities of intersex variations and the effect of harmful medical practices like Intersex genital Mutilation also know as unecessary "fixing" or "correcting" of intersex genitals."

In partnership with the NYSC officials, Intersex was able to engage NYSC members on intersex issues and how intersex discussion is a public health needed discussion.

Some corps members shared personal encounters with intersex persons but not knowing the right and proper way to engage with them. Intersex Nigeria team at the camp ground clarified the common myths and misconceptions corps members shared and answered some pressing and urgent FAQ like are intersex people not the same "hermaphrodites"?"

Intersex Nigeria further engaged the corps members through IEC materials to enable a ripple effect kind of advocacy in their respective primary place of assignments in different communities.

Solidarity Across Borders

Through the **VIRAL project** we gathered data on the lived experiences of intersex people, understanding social perceptions of the public, clarifying myths and misconceptions about intersex and promoting the human rights of intersex persons from healthcare providers, intersex people and their parents and the general public in Nigeria and Cameroon.

A validation of the data collected was done with the relevant stakeholders including CSOs, healthcare providers, intersex people. The VIRAL report further informs advocacy engagement with healthcare workers, including traditional births attendant, through workshops and trainings. We further established and engaged high level stakeholders from the **Federal Ministry Of Health and Social Welfare** (FMOSHW) , **Society of Gynaecology and Obstetrics of Nigeria**, **Nigerian Nursing and Midwifery Council**, **National Hospital Management Board,** among others.

Intersex Nigeria further engaged with the FMOHSW on the inclusion of intersex persons in National Healthcare Guidelines and Policies."

There is a clear absence of legal recognition and protection for intersex persons in Cameroon and Nigeria.

We took these conversations up to the Federal Ministry of Health and Social Welfare as well as other key agencies to show that protecting intersex people is a real public health issue, not just a private family matter. On the streets, we asked everyday people what they knew and shared facts through short videos and easy-to-read infographics in English and French.

The project also produced an Intersex-friendly Healthcare Toolkit with practical steps for better care and stronger consent. Small but important support was given to a few community members in Cameroon who needed help covering urgent medical costs.

On October 26, 2024, we launched the VIRAL Report to commemorate **Intersex Awareness Day**. The success of the event affirmed the power of research, storytelling and community in shifting the national conversation.

The Visibility Project

The "**Empowerment**, **Visibility**, and **Inclusion** of Intersex People in Nigeria" project was designed to respond to the long-standing exclusion of intersex persons from national conversations, legal protections and economic empowerment for self reliance.

Intersex Nigeria empowered intersex persons with high-end devices to learn digital skills including graphics and motion design, data analysis, cyber security and networking and computer literacy." Participants also receive financial literacy to understand basic literacy to enable them monetise their digital skills, manage budget and understand financial compliance such as PAYE etc.

Over the course of this training, a participant who was trained on Cybersecurity gained a promotion in their workplace as a result of their newly acquired skills.

To better understand and highlight the gaps in child protection laws, policies, and mechanisms addressing genital mutilation; and to expose the persistent exclusion of intersex children from these frameworks, Intersex Nigeria convened key actors from the FGM and child protection movements in Nigeria.
The dialogue sought to identify legal and policy shortcomings, explore opportunities for collaboration, and build intersectional strategies aimed at closing these gaps and improving the lives of intersex people from birth.

One of the central pillars of the project was the compilation of a report on violations experienced by intersex persons in Nigeria. Drawing from one-on-one conversations, intake forms and community engagements, we gathered evidence of non-consensual surgeries, forced hormonal treatment, rejection in schools and healthcare settings, and other forms of systemic harm.

Towards Sustainable Advocacy

In 2024, Intersex Nigeria achieved an important milestone with the development of the Strategic Advocacy Manual for Intersex Rights in Nigeria. The manual emerged from a three-day national consultation with activists, community members, civil society partners, and traditional influencers, facilitated by Omolara Oriye of Liberation Alliance Africa.

he consultation identified the pressing human rights challenges intersex persons face in Nigeria—especially when advocating for their own rights. It also provided space to reflect on good practices and methods that can guide more effective advocacy. Participants collectively defined advocacy goals, objectives, and actions that can be applied across grassroots and national contexts.

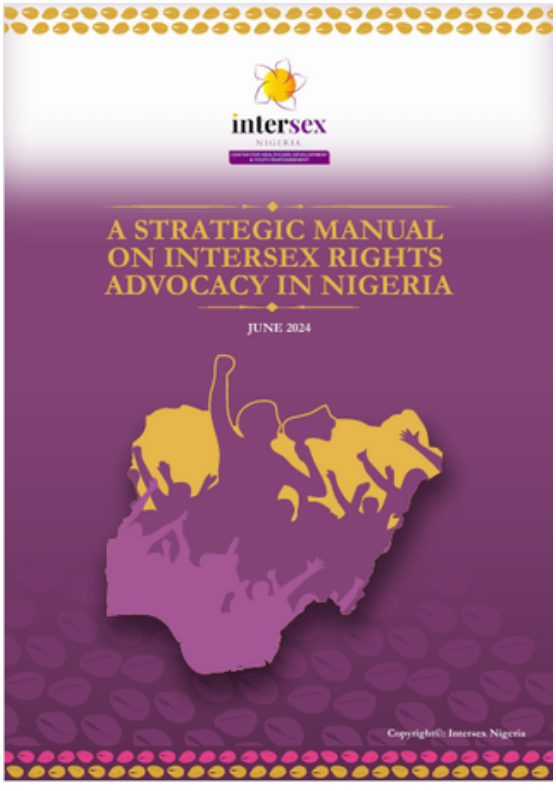
The manual provides a clear and practical framework, defining key concepts such as advocacy actions, objectives, and strategies. It is designed not only as a resource to be read from start to finish, but also as a reference tool that activists and organisations can return to for guidance.

The manual is structured in three sections and it highlights:

- Practical tools for framing advocacy efforts.
- Methods for building stronger campaigns on intersex rights.
- Guidelines for intersectional approaches that reflect the lived realities of intersex persons in Nigeria.

This resource now serves as one of the first comprehensive manuals tailored specifically to intersex advocacy in the country. It strengthens the capacity of intersex activists and allies, ensuring they can speak with a unified voice in demanding bodily autonomy, dignity, and recognition.

By producing this manual, Intersex Nigeria has provided the movement with a durable tool that bridges knowledge gaps, builds shared strategies, and lays the groundwork for stronger, collective action.



Uniting Perspectives for Justice

Guided by our mission of applying a feminist lens to all our work, Intersex Nigeria implemented the Intersex Equality and Equity Project, designed to raise public awareness and understanding of intersex realities. As part of the project, we convened a two-day feminist co-creation workshop with selected members of feminist organisations and advocates, where we collaboratively developed information, education, and communication (IEC) messaging. These feminist-informed co-created messages informed the creation of powerful advocacy tools to advance intersex rights, influence strategic government spaces, and strengthen human rights protection networks.

Participants worked together to develop educational resources that challenge stigma, raise awareness and support cross-movement advocacy. These included a human rights and advocacy toolkit, a directory of support services, inclusive communication guides and a digital campaign strategy for intersex visibility. The materials were designed for both physical and online use, making them adaptable for workshops, outreach events and digital storytelling.

The workshop created a foundation for future collaboration on shared priorities like bodily autonomy, mental health access and gender justice. Sessions were highly interactive and participants were able to co-design messaging that reflects intersex realities within broader feminist frameworks.

Feedback from the workshop highlighted the value of the collaborative format, the importance of clear objectives and the need to maintain inclusive and accessible language across all outputs.

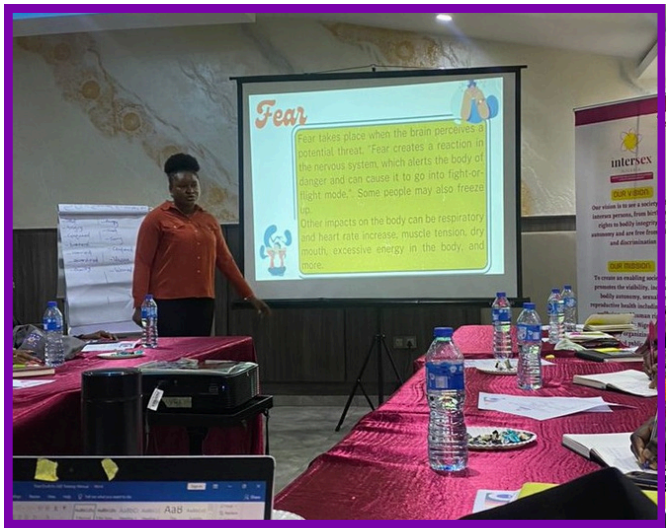
Rewriting the Script

Intersex Nigeria Launched a bold effort to shift how intersex people are represented in the media. This was a core activity of intersex Nigeria focused on our core thematic area for stakeholders mobilisation and representation. We brought together media professionals from different parts of Nigeria and across different media platforms, where we discussed tools for adequate media representation like, language justice, respectful images, positive media description, factual messaging, ethical storytelling, and the dangers of pathologising or sensationalising intersex bodies.

Participants from the workshop collectively declared their dedication to positively present/report intersex issues and stories. testimonials from the event where generally positive with a participant saying they were happy with the training and how much they had learned about intersex and intersex related issues.

A Year of Empowerment: The Engage, Encourage and Empower Program

The **Engage**, **Encourage** and **Empower** (EEE) program was created to provide a safe and affirming space for young people of SOGIESC identities navigating issues of self-worth and mental well-being as well as a space to learn the necessary life competency skills to properly integrate into the society and thrive. For this year's cohort, we welcomed ten participants and focused on strengthening life skills and emotional resilience. To do this, we developed a custom training manual tailored to their lived experiences, guiding sessions on key topics like self-awareness skills, Interpersonal relationship skills, thinking skills and mental health support through group psychotherapy session.



The program revealed critical insights into the complex social and emotional realities many of the participants face.

For many, the weight of familial tension, social exclusion, and economic hardship was evaluated in different sessions and through different lessons tailored to explore the relationship between participants and their social environments.

Our well-trained facilitation team worked towards integrated wellness practices such as deep breathing, stretching, and mindfulness at the beginning of each session. These moments of care helped create a more grounded and present learning atmosphere.

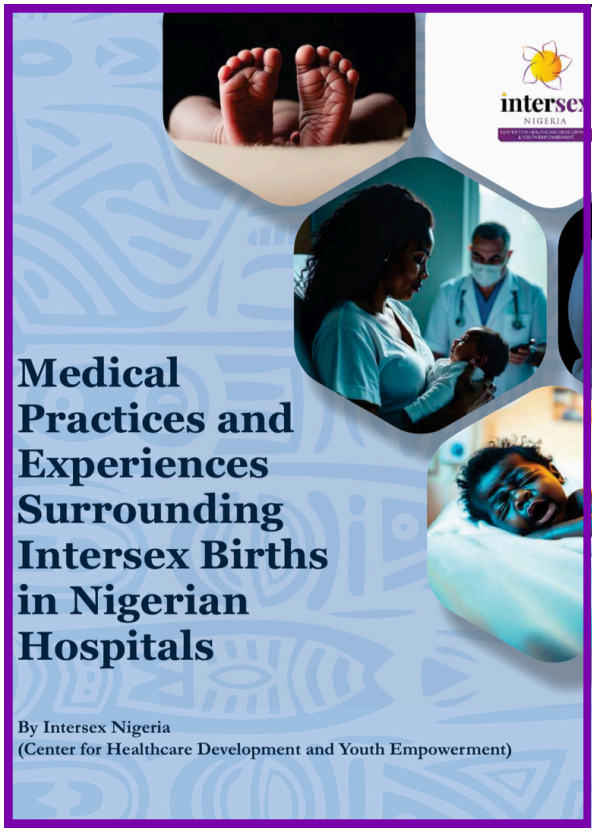
Beyond skill-building, the EEE program fostered a powerful sense of community, offering participants a space to feel seen and heard and build strong community. It served as a powerful reminder that healing and growth are possible even in difficult contexts.

In the coming phase, Intersex Nigeria plans to deepen the program's focus on trauma-informed care, mental health support, and leadership development. Our goal is to ensure participants are not just surviving but thriving.

Behind Closed Doors

The **Medical Practices and Experiences Surrounding Intersex Births in Nigerian Hospitals** uncovers what many Nigerian hospitals keep out of sight: how intersex bodies are treated behind closed doors and how non-consensual surgeries continue quietly, without challenge.

Working with a dedicated team of consultants, we gathered data from **50 hospitals** across **Nigeria's 6 geopolitical zones**.



This meant months of building trust with medical professionals, finding doctors willing to revisit old case notes and navigating layers of clearance and bureaucracy that often push intersex advocacy to the margins. Still, we persisted.

The result was one of the first comprehensive snapshots of how intersex genital mutilation (IGM) is carried out in Nigeria today. We documented how parents are pressured into irreversible decisions, how surgeries are explained only partially, or not at all, and how outdated beliefs about "normal" bodies continue to guide harmful medical practices.

We took these findings straight to the Federal Ministry of Health and Social Welfare, frontline health workers and partner organisations. The evidence has already strengthened our training materials for healthcare providers and shaped the Intersex-Friendly Healthcare Toolkit.

For many who read the final report, it was the first time they had seen undeniable proof that intersex children and their families face medical harm. This is not because it is necessary, but because no one has been held accountable to stop it.

Intersex Awareness Day 2024

On October 26, 2024, we celebrated Intersex Awareness Day with purpose and power. At the heart of the event was the official launch of our flagship research: the VIRAL Report (Visibility, Inclusion and Recognition of Intersex Persons Report). This report offers a look at the lived realities of intersex people in Nigeria and Cameroon. It covers access to healthcare, education, discrimination and social inclusion.

The event brought together different partners; activists, journalists, CSOs, academics, Human Rights Commission, Community members, allies, Healthcare professionals, and Federal Ministry of Health and Social Welfare.

We used the space to challenge sensationalist narratives, replace them with dignity-centred truths and demand action from key stakeholders.

Some attendees shared that the VIRAL Report was the first time they encountered intersex issues in such a comprehensive, evidence-based way.

The success of the event affirmed the power of research, storytelling, and community in shifting the national conversation. It also signalled the beginning of a new chapter for intersex visibility in Nigeria that is grounded in facts and lived experiences with the belief that we all deserve to be seen, heard and respected.

Strengthening Our National Voice: The Abuja Office

Our advocacy work has always been central to our mission, and in 2024, we took a pivotal step to amplify our impact. Recognizing the importance of engaging directly with policymakers and government bodies, we established a new office in Abuja.

This strategic presence allows us to facilitate more direct dialogue, engage in collaborative meetings and respond swiftly to policy opportunities. The Abuja office serves as our critical link to the nation's political capital, reinforcing our voice and ensuring our advocacy efforts are at the forefront of national conversations on human rights.

Field impact Stories

During one of our stakeholder sessions in Yaoundé, Cameroon, we met Esther*, a young woman who had never heard the term “intersex” before. Quiet at first, she later shared that as a child she had undergone surgeries she never understood. “I used to think I was a mistake,” she told us, “but now I know I’m not alone.”

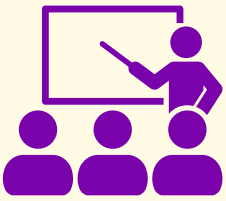
For Esther, the session was packed with knowledge. Afterward, she asked how to get involved in advocacy, determined to ensure no other child faces what she did in silence. Her story is a powerful reminder of why our work in Cameroon matters and why creating spaces for awareness and belonging must continue.

(*Name changed for privacy)

PROGRAM IMPACT

Behind every campaign, training and community gathering are people who engaged with us, asked questions, shared stories, and in some cases, took their very first steps into understanding intersex realities.

2024 By the Numbers



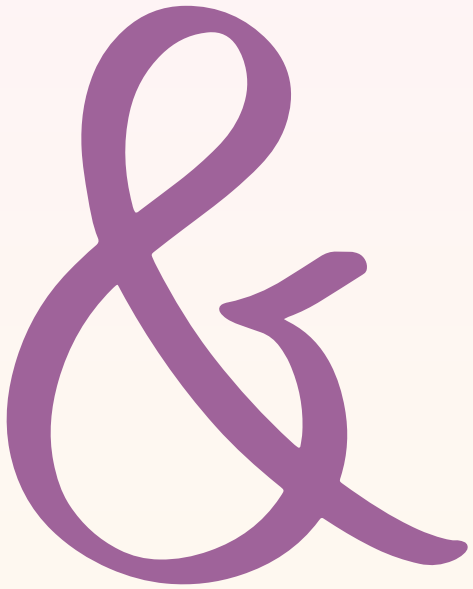
3,459

h**igh level stakeholders and policy makers** trained, supported or engaged via direct capacity-building engagements such as workshops, dialogues and intensive trainings.

11,112

those who engaged with our programs through awareness events, surveys and consultations.

Movement Building



Partnerships

Intersex Nigeria at United Nations Human Rights Council

In March 2024, our Executive Director joined intersex activists from around the world at the UN Human Rights Council's 55th Session informal consultations. These sessions provided space to share intersex realities directly with diplomats and member state representatives, shaping their understanding ahead of a historic vote.

By contributing Nigeria's perspective, Intersex Nigeria helped highlight how harmful practices like intersex genital mutilation and systemic invisibility violate human rights. This global solidarity and advocacy were instrumental in paving the way for the **adoption of the first-ever UN Resolution on the human rights of intersex persons in April 2024**, which created a foundation for stronger national advocacy by giving us a powerful tool to hold governments accountable to international standards

This milestone strengthened our resolve to continue bridging local advocacy with global change.

Strategic Engagement with National Human Rights Commission

In 2024, Intersex Nigeria strengthened its advocacy network by meeting with the Executive Secretary of the **National Human Rights Commission** (NHRC), **Dr. Anthony O. Ojukwu** SAN. The exchange provided us a platform to present our work and explore how the NHRC could support the promotion and protection of intersex rights in Nigeria.

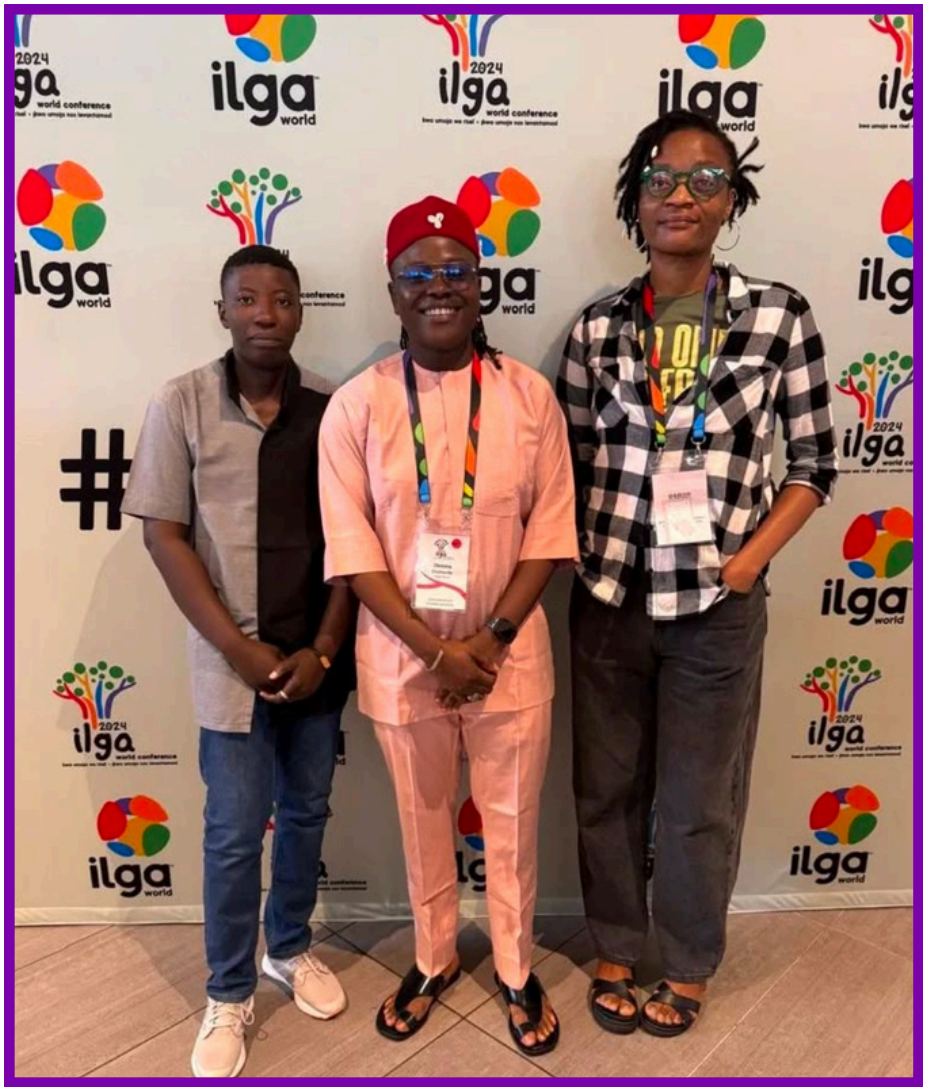
This visit was timely, following the regional adoption of **African Commission on Human and Peoples' Rights (ACHPR) Resolution 552** in March 2023 and the global step forward marked by the **UN Human Rights Council Resolution 55** in April 2024. Both resolutions affirm intersex rights as fundamental human rights.

By aligning these international milestones with national-level engagement, we opened doors for meaningful collaboration with the NHRC. All of our advocacy and movement-building efforts are to embed intersex rights more firmly within Nigeria's human rights landscape, from policy to practice.

ILGA World Conference – Cape Town, South Africa

In 2024, Intersex Nigeria joined the **ILGA World Conference** in Cape Town, South Africa. This global gathering created space for exchange among activists, advocates and human rights defenders advancing equality and inclusion.

We contributed to conversations that highlighted the realities of intersex persons in Nigeria, particularly around healthcare discrimination and harmful medical practices. The conference allowed us to engage with partners from across regions, forge alliances with organizations already working on bodily autonomy and raise visibility for intersex issues at an international level. These connections are important in strengthening our advocacy back home and positioning intersex rights as a core human rights concern.



We Lead Summit – Nairobi, Kenya

In 2024, Intersex Nigeria joined the **We Lead Summit** in Nairobi, Kenya, a three-day gathering that brought together rightsholders and community of action members from Kenya, Uganda and Nigeria. The summit created space to reflect on the diverse realities of young people across the region and the barriers they face in accessing their rights.

Our team shared the work we are doing in Nigeria to **amplify intersex voices, particularly in pushing for recognition, healthcare inclusion and protection** from harmful practices. Engaging with duty bearers, stakeholders and fellow COA members, we highlighted the lived realities of intersex persons and built connections with allies working across movements.

The summit reinforced an important truth for us as a regional community: solidarity in action remains the foundation for building sustainable and inclusive societies. Each story shared and each collaboration forged reminded us that advancing intersex rights cannot happen in isolation, but as part of a wider struggle for justice and equality.

AIDS Conference 2024 – Munich, Germany

At the **AIDS Conference** 2024 in Munich, our Executive Director, **Obioma Chukwuike**, joined a panel discussion titled "*How to Center the Perspectives of Young Women and Girls Living with HIV.*"

In their remarks, Obioma emphasized the urgent need to ensure that young **people in all their diversity** are not only seen as beneficiaries of HIV and AIDS programs but are recognized as **leaders shaping policy and intervention design**. They drew attention to how stigma and invisibility continue to affect intersex persons and linked this to broader challenges faced by other marginalized groups in accessing HIV prevention and treatment.

Obioma called on policymakers and donors to commit to intersectional and inclusive approaches that do not leave intersex persons behind. They reminded the audience that meaningful progress in the HIV response depends on putting every person's dignity at the center and ensuring that communities traditionally left out have a seat at the decision-making table.

This intervention was a contribution to the global HIV dialogue by placing intersex issues squarely within the world's largest HIV and AIDS convening.

AWID Forum – Bangkok, Thailand

Intersex Nigeria participated in the **AWID Forum** in Bangkok, Thailand, which id one of the largest global feminist convenings. The forum brought together activists, movements and organisations from around the world to share strategies for advancing rights and justice.

At the forum, **Intersex Nigeria's hosted a talk show**, which empowered intersex individuals and raising awareness about intersex experiences. We connected with allies, shared our experiences from Nigeria and drew inspiration from other movements confronting inequality and violence.

The forum also opened new pathways for collaboration and resource mobilisation, strengthening our capacity to continue advocating for intersex bodily autonomy and dignity.

8th National Family Planning Conference - Abuja

At the close of the year, Intersex Nigeria also joined the **8th National Family Planning Conference**, alongside stakeholders and partners committed to ensuring universal access to family planning services.

Our participation created an important platform to highlight how intersex people are often excluded from reproductive health conversations and to advocate for more inclusive approaches in family planning and SRHR policy.

This engagement reinforced our commitment to placing intersex voices at the center of broader health dialogues in Nigeria.

Empowering Young Feminist Leaders

From December 12-13, 2024, FRIDA (The Young Feminist Fund) and WHER joined forces to host the "**Bridging Leadership with Action**" event. The two-day workshop was designed to empower a new generation of young feminist leaders by providing them with actionable strategies to lead effectively through a feminist lens.

The event moved beyond theory and focused on deep-dive methods and practical, implementable approaches. Participants engaged in a series of interactive exercises and empathetic discussions, exploring how to embed feminist leadership principles within social development organizations and as advocates and activists.

A central objective was to deepen participants' understanding of feminist leadership and equip them with the skills to address complex, intersectional barriers. Through open dialogue, we collectively explored the significance of identifying and dismantling bias (both personal and organisational) as a critical step toward authentic and transformative leadership. The event successfully fostered skill-building and equipped attendees with the tools to lead with greater empathy, awareness and impact.

Civil Society & Human Rights Defenders Forum 2024 - Abuja

In December 2024, Intersex Nigeria participated in the **Civil Society Organizations and Human Rights Defenders Forum and Human Rights Expo**, organized by the **National Human Rights Commission** in Abuja as part of Human Rights Week. The forum convened human rights experts, UN agencies, diplomatic missions, and civil society leaders to reflect on urgent human rights issues in Nigeria.

The sessions covered a wide range of themes, from civic space and freedom of assembly, to climate change, corruption, business accountability, migration, SGBV, and non-discrimination. Intersex Nigeria contributed to discussions that underscored the importance of protecting marginalized communities and advancing inclusive human rights policies.

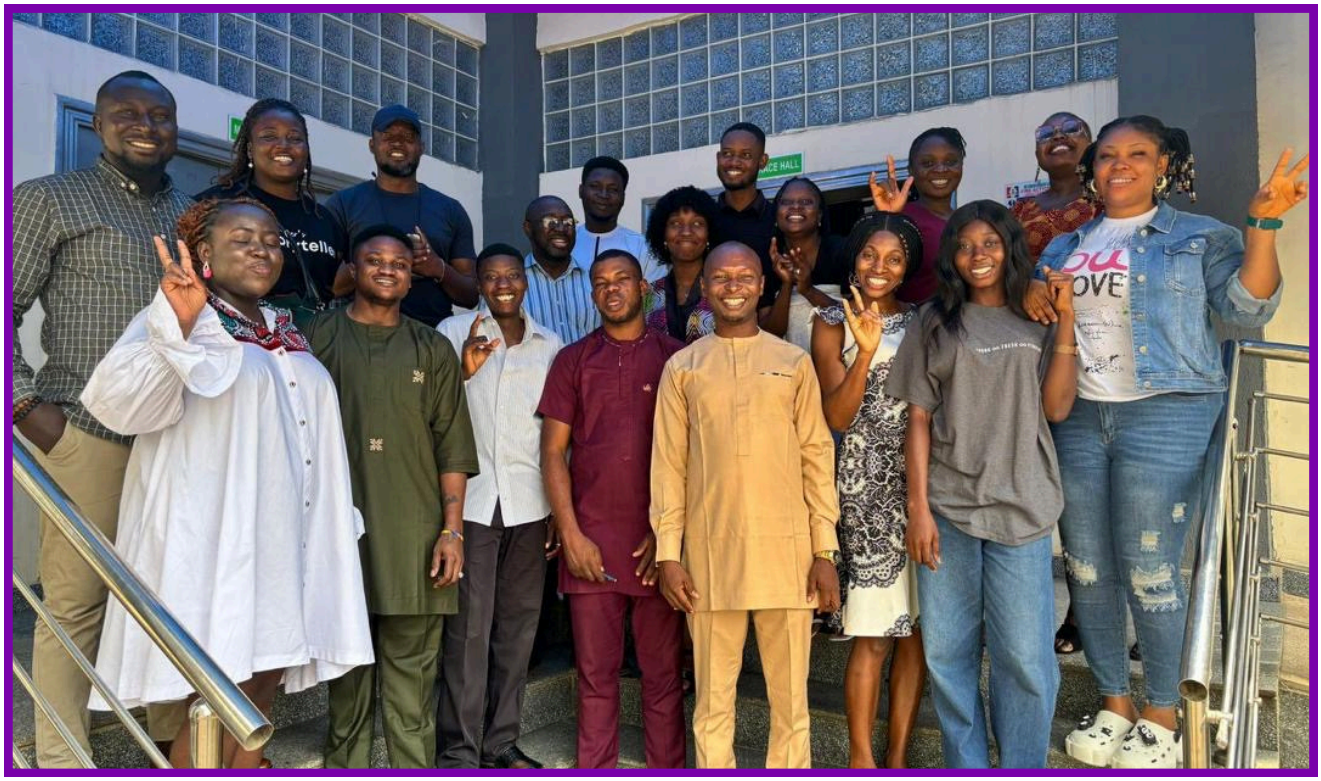
Our participation not only strengthened our visibility within Nigeria's wider human rights movement but also provided opportunities to build alliances, share experiences, and shape policy conversations. The outcomes of the forum fed into communiques and policy documents designed to strengthen partnerships between rights holders and duty bearers, creating actionable steps for advancing human rights protections across the country.

We Lead Safety and Security Workshop - Abuja

Our work in the community requires a constant focus on safety and security and the "**WE LEAD**" workshop was a critical step in building that awareness. We learned that while we can't eliminate every risk, we can empower ourselves with knowledge and proactive strategies. The core lesson was to always be aware, anticipate potential threats and have a plan of action ready to go.

The training covered a range of practical measures for personal safety. We were advised to be disciplined and methodical, avoiding predictable routines that could make us vulnerable.

This workshop remind us to be mindful of what we share (rom information about ourselves to the backgrounds in our selfies) because even small details can empower a criminal. By integrating these lessons, we are not only better prepared to protect ourselves and our assets but also to continue our work with greater confidence and security, ensuring our movement can thrive even in a challenging environment.



SRHR Inclusivity Workshop – Abuja

In November 2024, Intersex Nigeria participated in the four-day workshop on Enhancing SRHR Inclusivity Through Gender Identity, Diversity, and Values Clarification, organized by **WHER** and **HIVOS** in Abuja. The workshop brought together 35 participants from 12 organizations to strengthen understanding of sexual and reproductive health and rights (SRHR) through the lens of diversity, bodily autonomy, and values clarification.

Our representatives contributed intersex perspectives during sessions on stigma, discrimination and inclusive healthcare. Key conversations explored the principles of SRHR, the role of state and non-state actors and strategies for advancing inclusive policies. The workshop also created space for joint advocacy planning and highlighted storytelling as a powerful tool for driving change.

Through this engagement, Intersex Nigeria helped ensure that intersex realities were reflected in the broader SRHR discourse while also strengthening collaboration with allied organizations committed to inclusive health systems.

Youth Leadership Training, Abuja

We attended this year's Youth Leadership Training as part of our movement-building efforts. It brought together young leaders to re-examine what it truly means to lead. Over the course of three days, participants learned about leadership skills. By embracing an intersectional approach, we discovered how to leverage our personal power to build a more collaborative movement where every voice is heard and valued.

The training also provided practical strategies for navigating our organisational structure, teaching us to effectively lead upwards, across and downwards. We also learned to lead with our core values, ensuring our actions remain aligned with our shared goals. A recurring theme was the importance of resiliencefor overcoming challenges and sustaining our long-term advocacy work.

Ultimately, this training equipped our young leaders with more understanding of their roles as advocates and change-makers. It reinforced their confidence to create positive change in their communities. The lessons learned will continue to strengthen our movement as we work toward an inclusive future.

Lessons and Challenges

Challenges

1. Long term and core funding remains a constraint to ensuring long term planning and sustainability of our initiatives.
2. Staff retention is increasingly difficult with limited longterm resources.
3. Language barriers reduce outreach efforts to rural communities in Nigeria.
4. Text-heavy communication received less engagement than illustrations, requiring more allocation of resources to visual communication.
5. Online and physical safety and security remains a major concern in our advocacy and outreach efforts.

Lessons Learned

1. Investing in visual and creative communication is essential for stronger audience and community engagement.
2. Challenges led to strengthening of systems for sustainable growth.
3. Translation of resource materials to multiple languages ensures inclusivity and wider reach of audience.
4. Even within funding constraints, collaboration and cross-movement partnerships amplify impact and visibility.
5. We learned the most effective way to manage risks is by empowering staff and community with personal awareness and collective responsibility.

Looking Ahead

1

Expand Programs & Partnerships: We will continue to grow the scope of our programs and reach new partners and stakeholders to increase our impact.

2

Strengthen Advocacy: We will enhance our advocacy efforts at both national and international levels to promote intersex rights and awareness.

3

Empower Communities: We will continue to empower intersex individuals and allied communities through education and community-strengthening engagements.

4

Enhance Communication: We will shift to more visual and creative storytelling and provide multilingual resources to ensure our message is inclusive .

5

Fortify Team Resilience: We will continue to empower our staff with proactive security protocols and strengthening a culture of collective responsibility.

2024 Financial Audit Report Summary

Report of the Auditors

ODHOMOR B-A & CO
(Chartered Accountants)
FINANCIAL CONSULTANT, AUDIT, TAX MANAGEMENT, BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT PLANS.
08062323154, 08094648722, 08052357702

LAGOS OFFICE:
Citi House, 1st Floor, Wing A, 116-118,
Ago Palace Way, Okota, Isolo, Lagos.

WARRI OFFICE:
51, Ugborikoko Road, Effurun, Delta State.
Email: bennwaogu4006@gmail.com

INDEPENDENT AUDITORS REPORT TO THE TRUSTEES OF CENTER FOR HEALTH CARE DEVELOPMENT AND YOUTH EMPOWERMENT

We have audited the financial statements of Center for Health Care Development and Youth Empowerment, for the year 31ST DECEMBER,2024 as set out on pages 5 to 11 which comprise statement of accounting policies, statement of financial position,statementof income and expenditure,statement of cash receipts and payment, statement of Comprehensive income and Notes to the financial statements for the period, then ended.

MANAGEMENT'S RESPONIBILITY FOR THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS.

The management of Intersex nigeria is responsible for the preparation and a fair presentation of these financial statements in accordance with the international financial Reporting Standards (IFRS) in the manner required by the the Companies and Allied Matters Act of Nigeria,the Financial Reporting Council of Nigeria Act , 2011 guidelines and circulars, to the extent that they do not conflict with the requirements of IFRS.This Responsibility includes designing, implementing and maintaing internal control system relevant to the preparation and fair presentation of financial statemnts free from whether due to fraud or error, selecting and applying appropriate accounting policies, and making accounting estimate that are reasonable in the circumstances.

AUDITOR'S RESPONSIBILITY

Our responsibility is to express an opinion on these financial statements based on our audit, Which we conducted in accordance with international standards on auditing . Those standards require that we comply with ethical requirements and plan and perform the audit to obtain reasonable assurance whether the financial statements are free from material misstatement.
An audit involves performing procedures to obtain audit evidance about the amount and disclosures in the Financial statements. The procedures selected depend on our judgement, including assessment of the risk of material misstatement of the financial statements, whether due to fraud or error. In making those risk assessments.the auditor consider the internal controls relevant to the entity's preparation and fair presentaion of the financial statements in order to design audit , audit procedures that are appropriate in the circumstances.for the purpose expressing an opinion on the effectiveness of the entity's internal control .An audit also includes evaluting the appropriateness of accounting policies used and the reasonabless of accounting estimate made by Trustees , as well as evaluating overall presentation of the financial statements. We believe that the audit evidence we have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for the opinion

OPINION

In our opinion, the organization has kept proper books of account and the financial Statements are in agreement with the records in all material respects,and give in the prescribed manner, information required by the COMPANIES AND Allied Matters Act of Nigeria 2020, and the financial reporting Council Act, The financial statements give a true and fair view of the financial position of Center for Health Care Development and Youth Empowerment as at 31st, December 2024 and of its financial performance and its receipt and payment for the period then ended.

REPORT ON OTHER LEGAL AND REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

Compliance with the requirement of schedule 6of theCompanies and Allied Matters Act ofNigeria 2020
In our opinion, proper books of accounts have been kept by the organization, so far as appaers from our examination of those books and the organization's financial position statements and the statements of comprehensive income are in agreement with the books of accounts.

INSTITUTE OF CHARTERED ACCOUNTANTS OF NIGERIA
ICAN
0034617

ODHOMOR B.A
FRCN/ICAN/2013/0000011906
For; Odhomor B-A & Co
(Chartered Accountants)
JUNE, 2025

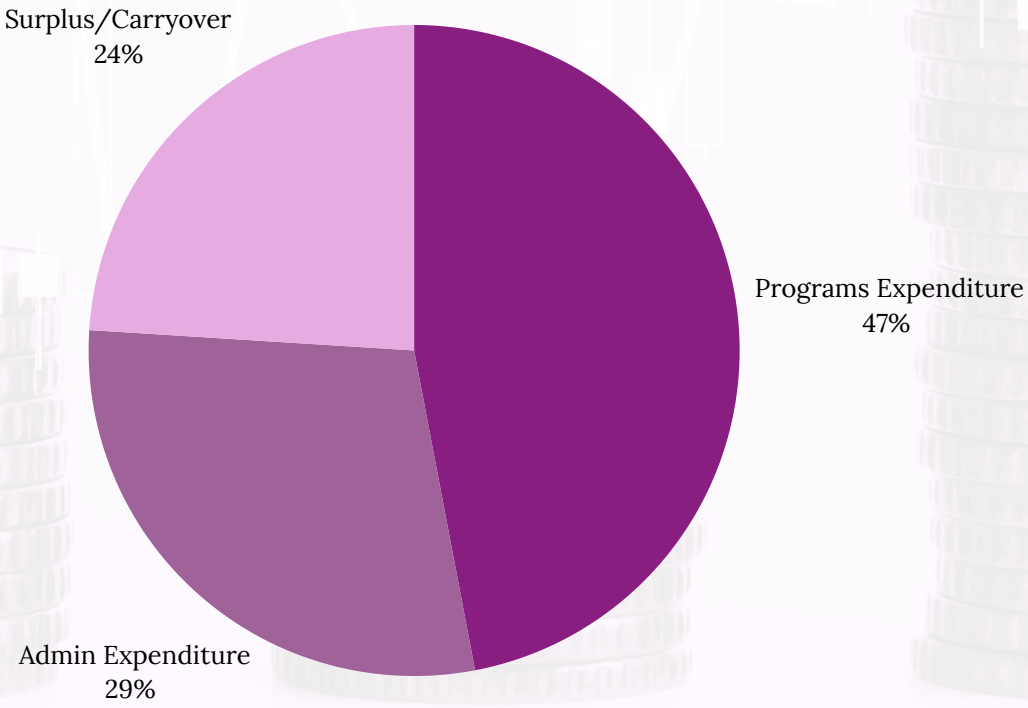
Income and Expenditure Summary

Table 1: Income

INCOME	N309,040,000

Table 2: Expenditure

PROGRAMS EXPENDITURE	N146,619,201
ADMIN EXPENDITURE	N89,989,187
SURPLUS/CARRYOVER	N72,431,612



Appreciation

We are grateful to every donor, partner, ally and our community who stood with us in 2024. Your trust, funding, and flexibility gave us room to listen deeper, push harder and carry intersex stories into places they had never reached before.

In no particular order, we thank OSIWA, ISDAO, Astraea Foundation, FRIDA, HIVOS, COC Netherland, Outright International, Mama Cash, AWDF, EMpower, the Federal Ministry of Health and Social Welfare and every individual and organisational partner who walked this path with us; thank you for believing that intersex rights matter and for helping us protect the dignity of people too often pushed aside.

Your support is the reason we can keep showing up, keep learning and keep building a future where intersex people are seen, heard and free.

Intersex Nigeria

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www.intersexnigeria.org